

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-02

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 17:16-27

16 Then King David went in and sat before the Lord; and he said: "Who am I, O Lord God? And what is my house, that You have brought me this far?

17 And yet this was a small thing in Your sight, O God; and You have also spoken of Your servant's house for a great while to come, and have regarded me according to the rank of a man of high degree, O Lord God.

18 What more can David say to You for the honor of Your servant? For You know Your servant.

19 O Lord, for Your servant's sake, and according to Your own heart, You have done all this greatness, in making known all these great things.

20 O Lord, there is none like You, nor is there any God besides You, according to all that we have heard with our ears.

21 And who is like Your people Israel, the one nation on the earth whom God went to redeem for Himself as a people—to make for Yourself a name by great and awesome deeds, by driving out nations from before Your people whom You redeemed from Egypt?

22 For You have made Your people Israel Your very own people forever; and You, Lord, have become their God.

23 "And now, O Lord, the word which You have spoken concerning Your servant and concerning his house, let it be established forever, and do as You have said.

24 So let it be established, that Your name may be magnified forever, saying, 'The Lord of hosts, the God of Israel, is Israel's God.' And let the house of Your servant David be established before You.

25 For You, O my God, have revealed to Your servant that You will build him a house. Therefore Your servant has found it in his heart to pray before You.

26 And now, Lord, You are God, and have promised this goodness to Your servant.

27 Now You have been pleased to bless the house of Your servant, that it may continue before You forever; for You have blessed it, O Lord, and it shall be blessed forever.

II. Key Summary

- David went in and sat before the Lord, and the first thing he said was "Who am I, O Lord God? And what is my house, that You have brought me this far?" (vv. 16-18).
 - He declared that there is none like God and no God besides Him, and recalled how God redeemed Israel out of Egypt to be His own people forever (vv. 20-22).
 - He asked God to establish the word He had spoken and to do as He had said, explaining that he prayed because God had revealed, "You will build him a house" (vv. 23-27).
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III. Passage Analysis

A huge gift, and all he sees is how great God is

When David received this spectacular gift, he didn't think it made him any greater. In David's eyes it made God greater. David's attitude wasn't "I am so great that even God gives me gifts." His attitude was, "God is so great that He gives even me gifts." [1]

God had just turned down David's plan to build the temple and then promised him far more than he asked for. David's response was to sit down before God and ask, "Who am I?" The same event can make a person feel impressive, or it can make them see how good the Giver is — David saw the Giver.

He dared to ask because God had spoken first

David prayed that God would "bless it forever" (v. 27) not because he deserved it, but because God had revealed, "I will build you a house" (v. 25) — that is why he "found it in his heart to pray before You" (v. 25). [2]

David's prayer was bold, but the confidence did not come from himself; he simply handed God's own words back to Him and asked Him to do as He had said. That is why he could call himself "Your servant" ten times in this prayer and still ask for "forever."

IV. Reflection Question

If you sat down right now the way David did and asked, "Who am I?" — what is one thing you have that you never earned or asked for?

David started his prayer by counting everything back to God, and only then did he dare to ask boldly — his confidence came from what God had already said: "I will build you a house."

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, 1 Chronicles 17,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-17/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy), 歷代志上聖經綜合解讀 (translated from Chinese),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT17.htm>